



ROOIBOS

(*Aspalathus linearis*)

Also known as redbush, this oxidized herbal drink is mostly consumed as a caffeine-free black tea substitute and is also available as an unoxidized leaf. It provides a neutral base that blends well with fruits, spices, and other flavors. Rooibos contains antioxidants and helps with insomnia, digestion, and blood circulation. It grows only in the Western Cape region of South Africa.

TULSI

(*Ocimum tenuiflorum*)

Native to India, tulsi (or holy basil) has strong antioxidant properties, a sweet flavor, and fragrant aroma. It has been used to relieve headache, cold and flu symptoms, as well as anxiety, and boosts concentration and memory. The tulsi plant can absorb toxic chromium from the soil, so try to purchase it from an organic source.

BASIL

(*Ocimum basilicum*)

Basil is much more than a kitchen staple; it is a powerful anti-inflammatory, high in antioxidants, and helps treat the symptoms of cold and flu. The combination of sweet licorice and savory flavors makes it an interesting ingredient in herbal blends.

YERBA MATE

(*Ilex paraguariensis*)

Grown mostly in Brazil and Argentina, this evergreen plant is high in caffeine. It has faint hints of tobacco and green tea flavors, and is known to improve mental energy as well as mood.



GOURD AND BOMBILLA

Yerba mate is traditionally infused in a hollow gourd and sipped through a "bombilla," or straw.